

IRANKUNDA Elyssa

Founder & CEO of ATAS



IRANKUNDA Elyssa is the Founder & CEO of ATAS (Alliance for Transformative AI Systems), a Kigali-based Rwandan AI research and product company building systems that understand Rwanda - its languages, geography, culture, and everyday realities. He leads ATAS end to end, from research to shipped products.

AT A GLANCE

ROLE

Founder & CEO, ATAS

FOCUS

Rwanda-first AI infrastructure

BASED

Kigali, Rwanda

WEBSITE

ielyssa.com

FOUNDED

2025

ATAS

atas.rw

WHAT ATAS BUILDS

■ AcademiaPlus

National curriculum infrastructure for Rwandan secondary education, bringing curriculum coverage, real exam evidence, and learning insight into one system. Entering its first schools.

■ IMIZI

A long-term research program for contextual intelligence infrastructure - helping AI understand Rwandan places, language, and lived context natively.

■ Kinyarwanda language technology

Original speech and language research built natively for Kinyarwanda, as a foundation for products that must understand Rwanda.

READ MORE

Website ielyssa.com

ATAS atas.rw

Biography ielyssa.com/biography

LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/ielyssa

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IRANKUNDA Elyssa is the Founder & CEO of ATAS - Alliance for Transformative AI Systems - a Rwandan AI research and product company based in Kigali, founded in 2025. He started ATAS on a conviction: AI that matters for Rwanda has to be built here, from Rwandan needs, not adapted from elsewhere and translated after the fact.

Under his leadership, ATAS runs research and product as one pipeline. AcademiaPlus is its active product: national curriculum infrastructure for Rwandan secondary education, entering its first schools. IMIZI is its long-term research program: contextual intelligence infrastructure designed to help AI understand Rwandan places and context natively. Underneath both sits original Kinyarwanda speech and language research.

Elyssa leads ATAS end to end, from problem selection and research direction through product design, engineering, and deployment. He began building software in secondary school and continues to work from real local constraints, with a long-term commitment to AI capability Rwanda can own.

SPEAKING & MEDIA TOPICS

01 Rwanda-first AI and building for local realities	02 Language, geography, and context-native AI
03 Turning research into products people can use	04 Founder journey, self-directed learning, and building with limited resources

CONTACT

For interviews, speaking invitations, partnerships, and collaboration:
info@ielyssa.com | +250 788 235 574

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